Cole Smith

Austin, Texas 78722 | 512-567-2933 | cas8698@my.utexas.edu | github.com/csmith454

EDUCATION

The University of Texas at Austin

M.A., Russian, East European, and Eurasian Studies, *GPA: 3.95* May 2027

- Thesis: Forthcoming, "Whack-a-mole: The Shadow Fleet and Sanctions on Russia"

B.A., International Relations and Global Studies, *GPA: 3.96* May 2024

- Capstone: "A Thawed Conflict: the Impact of Arctic Shipping on Sámi and Iñupiaq Peoples"

CERTIFICATIONS

Fundamentals for Teaching Assistants December 2026

Center for Teaching and Learning at the University of Texas at Austin

Elements of Computing December 2024

Department of Computer Science at the University of Texas at Austin

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

UGS 303: The Hidden Lives of Maps, *Teaching Assistant* January 2026 - May 2026

- Led 3 weekly discussions sections for 50+ students, guiding them through complex cartographic theory and application
- Mentored students in and outside of weekly office hours to provide constructive feedback, career advice, and helpful resources

UGS 303: Seekers and Mystics, *Teaching Assistant* August 2025 - December 2025

- Led 2 weekly discussions sections for 40+ students, facilitating understanding of difficult historical and religious texts.
- Conducted a guest lecture that presented and let students reflect on global traditions of Shamanism to a class of 100

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

"Russian Arteries of Influence," *Graduate Research Assistant* January 2026 - present

- Synthesized more than 20 publications related to Russian energy and European dependence
- Crafted 3 original datasets detailing Bulgarian government and energy history using techniques such as webscraping, PDF parsing, and clear database organization
- Utilized original data analysis to contribute to Dr. Mary Neuburger's complication of stories of European energy dependence and Russia's 'energy weapon'
- Presented at the Energy & Power in Russia, Eastern Europe and Eurasia Symposium at the University of Texas at Austin, April 10th, 2026

"How Elite Beliefs Change During a Defection Cascade" September 2025 - February 2026

- Conducted original data analysis on more than 12,000 answers from the ICPSR Survey of Russian Elites, Moscow, Russia, 1993-2020
- Integrated more than 10 publications on the ICPSR Survey with study of Elite Theory, utilizing Michael Burton and John Higley's scholarship
- Presented at the poster session for the Eurasia Policy Symposium at the AT&T Conference Center on February 12th, 2026

Cole Smith

Austin, Texas 78722 | 512-567-2933 | cas8698@my.utexas.edu | github.com/csmith454

PUBLICATIONS

Neuburger, Mary C. Evan Samsky & Cole A. Smith (Forthcoming) “Russian Arteries of Influence” in *Contemporary Russia in World History: A Hinge Nation in a Multipolar World?* edited by Choi Chatterjee and Karen Petrone. OUP.

AWARDS

Professional Development Award from CREEES — April 2026
Truitt Fellowship Award — August 2025

LANGUAGES

Russian (Intermediate)
Spanish (Fluent)